the Rome and Vienna airports, killing twenty people, including an eleven-year-old American girl and four other Americans. Colonel Muammar Qaddafi promptly called the suicide attack a “noble act.”

On the body of one of the terrorists was a Tunisian passport. The passport had been taken by Libyan officials from a Tunisian worker at the time he was expelled from Libya. It wasn’t hard to figure out where the terrorist had gotten the passport.

I felt we couldn’t ignore the mad clown of Tripoli any longer. By now, we had a shelf full of contingency plans designed to express in a concrete way our displeasure with his terrorism—but whatever we did, we had to take into account the presence of nearly one thousand American oil workers in Libya. Qaddafi wouldn’t think twice about taking his vengeance on them.

Two of my cabinet members whom I admired most, Cap Weinberger and George Shultz, never got along especially well together. There was always a little chill—a tension—between them. I suspect that it went back to when they were both executives of the Bechtel Corporation in San Francisco. Whatever it was, they didn’t see eye to eye on a lot of things. Sometimes, for example, Cap thought that George was too eager to enter into certain arms control agreements with the Soviets and tried to advise me to go more slowly than George favored (I’ll get into this later). There were numerous conflicts between them. I don’t think this was necessarily bad for the country or for the administration: Every member of the cabinet had to view the problems of the nation and interpret world events from the special vantage point of his or her own job and responsibilities, based in part on the advice of specialists in their respective departments.

Conflicts between the Pentagon and Foggy Bottom were inevitable no matter who ran them, and they didn’t start